Week 8 | Real-book guide

December 7 to 11 | A family prepares for winter, and each penguin responds in a different way.

One book, all subjects

Little Penguins | A family prepares for winter, and each penguin responds in a different way. Math: Compare picture groups of winter clothes or penguins with the week's fraction comparison strips. Science: Explore how clothing materials help keep a pretend penguin warm; observe and compare the test safely. Social studies: Recognize that family members can make different choices and identify ways a community prepares for cooler weather. Finish: Design a winter-weather outfit for a paper penguin and label each clothing choice.

Grade 3 | Little Penguins

Cynthia Rylant | Winter picture-book story

Prepare

one copy of Little Penguins; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Little Penguins to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are individual; the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are shared.

2026-12-07: Answer who and where questions; identify the first event with a picture or page clue. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-08: Answer what happened next and place that event in the sequence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-09: Retell the beginning, middle and end with three visual event cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-10: Answer a why or how question with a picture, AAC response or page detail. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-11: Retell the event sequence and answer three new story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Little Penguins

Cynthia Rylant | Winter picture-book story

Prepare

one copy of Little Penguins; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Little Penguins to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are individual; the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are shared.

2026-12-07: Find the story problem and explain a character's first action with an illustration. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-08: Sequence a character's action and explain what changes next. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-09: Explain the beginning, middle and end, including how a character responds. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-10: Explain why a character acts and show a page clue for the result. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-11: Explain the problem and solution; support one answer with page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.